

Clearview's Greatest Citizen Succumbs

CLEARVIEW, Okla. — (Special)—The obsequies of Doctor Major Clemon Alford was Tuesday, July 16, 1940, 1:00 p. m. with Reverend H. C. Lyner, "Pastor." Hundreds filled the new combination gym and auditorium to capacity with throngs outside listening by the accommodation of a public address system. Old timers say, Alford's funeral was the largest in the history of Clearview, with people from all parts of Oklahoma and out of state. Dr. Alford was born in Conklin, Mass., 39 years ago. After his preparatory training he took his professional study at Meharry College where he completed the Medical and Pharmaceutical course, came to Oklahoma in 1902 and later in Clearview constructed, owned and operated the Clearview Drugs, which is the city's only drug. As years passed by he undertook many civic and business enterprises in which he was a tremendous success. The Clearview Rural association; Former President of School Board and member; Farm Product Exchange; Oil, releases, and royalties; Loans and real estate. From these undertakings a vast fortune was accumulated which included property in Oklahoma, Arkansas, Louisiana and Mississippi. The many eulogies given during the last ritual some definitely proved Doctor Major Clemon Alford was Clearview's most outstanding and prominent citizen. Rev. H. C. Lyner, pastor of Church of Christ, Okmulgee, Oklahoma as he waded into the greatness of the Dr. Alford pointed out how the Lord had blessed others by blessing this man who had done many helpful things for his community, one was cited as the good for the better (Doctor Alford donated the construction of a new church there in Clearview) He constantly reminded his hearers to accept Christ as their great leader had done; a solo by Rev. H. R. Jackson; acknowledgement of condolences, Mrs. O. W. Word; obituary, J. C. Bush; Life as a Church Member, Elder C. W. Mayberry; His life as a Christian, Prof. Ira D. Hall. Hall unquestionably cited him as Clearview's ALL time greatest citizen. His meekness and commonplace understanding of coordination and participation with all people, which kept him from being classed as the average man of wealth. He was not ostentatious or aristocratic in any manner although his wealth and training allowed him to accept the most exclusive grandeur and molten gold in foreign or neighboring lands, but this noble citizen unlike his peers decided to Cast Down His Bucket here in this all Negro Metropolis among his own people. This quality denotes the finest of life to remain in this town where civilization has been hindered by racial misunderstanding and the misguided coordinating influences which has to eradicate in bonds of unity and cooperation before it can march a vast with times. His profound interest in Educational guidance of alertness for the community the academic and physical expansion of the Clearview school system is a living monument for its town. His philanthropic meritorious among his race and relations increases the magnitude of a greatness as a citizen. Many too knew of his extraordinary life and interest in the welfare of this community and he wanted certain accomplishments; wanted the people to organize and gain the only way any people can; he wanted the school to operate smoothly without extreme friction; and for years he tried to get the TRANSFER MONEY DUE THE SCHOOL DISTRICT. There were many interest in this great man, but we found him a great success in those matters where he worked alone and particularly his greatest achievement was in real estate and exchange. His economic philosophy and skill unfolded itself into unlimited wealth and political influence. One among his greatest economic hobbies, was the buying of Tax Sale property located in Negro settlements and many instances he would buy all of the Negro property offered for sale. One can explain his life by citing the 'Bridge Builder' yes he was a bridge builder for his people. The honorary Pallbearers: Robert Partridge, Foster Ligons, Rev. I. H. Haynes, O. E. Evans, Dr. J. H. C. Lucas and Prof. Terrell. Active Pallbearers: O. C. Irving, Ira D. Hall, O. M. Armstrong, C. W. Mayberry, A. T. Golden, Joseph Marks, Rev. H. Hargrove, Frank Bush. Honorary Flower Bearers: Mrs. O. C. Irving, Mrs. J. E. Thompson, Mrs. S. Haynes, Mrs. Sophia Hyatt, Mrs. Lenola Reynolds, Mrs. M. E. Lucas, Flower Bearers: Miss Marie Young, Mrs. Mary Ann Bush, Mrs. D. A. Chalmers, Miss Inez Daniels, Miss Olive Owens, Miss Naomi Chilton and Mrs. Ruth Wright. His most beautiful and most exclusive sealed metallic casket, well covered with flowers was lowered slowly to a rest in the new addition to the Clearview cemetery donated by Dr. Alford. The Anderson Funeral Home, Okmulgee, Oklahoma was in charge. Surviving are his wife, Mrs. J. Blank Alford; Mrs. E. V. Mayberry, daughter; Booker T. Alford, son; Mrs. Gamble, sister; Matt and Fayette Alford, bro.; Al T. Mayberry, grandson and a host of relatives and friends witnessing the last observation of their greatest citizen.